

Do gender quotas increase the election of female MPs? An analysis of the correlation between intra-party gender quotas and electoral results in Australia*

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May 13, 2026

Gender disparities among political candidates, within and across political parties, are not novel. Using data sourced from the Australian Electoral Commission (AEC), this analysis highlights the stark difference in female and male political candidates in the Australian House of Representatives. In a positive light, this paper will also support that there have been recent advancements in the number of female Australian political candidates serving as Members of Parliament, for instance, through gender quotas within parties.

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*Code and data from this analysis are available at: https://github.com/sabrinakreyzerman-k/Donaldson_Paper_Gender_in_Australian_Elections.

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1 Introduction

Introduction goes here.

2 Methodology

2.1 Data Collection

Data Collection goes here.

2.2 Data Overview

Table 1: Number of female Labor Party MPs elected directly following new gender quotas

Election Year	Number of Female MPs
1993	6
1996	3
2013	5
2016	13

In Table [1](#), blah blah blah.

Table 2: Number of female Liberal Party MPs elected directly following new Labor Party gender quotas

Election Year	Number of Female MPs
1993	4
1996	17
2013	6
2016	3

3 Findings

Findings goes here.

4 Discussion

Discussion goes here.

5 Exclusions & Future Research

One variable I chose to exclude from my data set was the age of political candidates. This is primarily because the age of many political candidates was not documented, impeding a comprehensive look on age as a variable considered by voters. While beyond the scope of my analysis, future research can look to advance the works of ..., which support that age is, in fact, an important characteristic in electoral politics. Future research can focus on how age either increases or decreases chances of election and why voters may be deterred or compelled by younger or older candidates. Future research can also explore a potential relationship between the gender and age of political candidates and odds of election.

6 Conclusion

Conclusion goes here.

7 References